

Word family: **discipline / disciplines / disciplined / disciplining / disciplinary / disciplinarian**

Base word: discipline

Forms: disciplines, disciplined, disciplining

Related forms: disciplined, disciplinary, disciplinarian

Useful compound: self-discipline

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adjective and person noun (相關形容詞及人物名詞)

Your sentence:

> “It reminds me of a period in my life when I was trying to become more **disciplined** and independent.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **disciplined** means **able to control your own behaviour, habits, attention, and effort so that you consistently do what you should do, even when it is difficult or tempting not to**.

繁體中文： **有自律的；能控制自己的行為、時間和習慣，並持續按照目標行事的**

中文翻譯：

> “...I was trying to become more **disciplined** and independent.”

「.....那時我正努力讓自己變得更加**自律**和獨立。」

Here:

disciplined = 有自制力、做事有規律、有目標地管理自己

1. **discipline = self-control / ability to control your behaviour (自律) — 自律；自制力**

This is the core meaning behind your passage.

Meaning: The ability to control your behaviour, emotions, habits, or attention in order to achieve something or follow a standard.

Practice 1

> “Learning a language requires **discipline**.”

「學習語言需要**自律**。」

Practice 2

> “She has the **discipline** to practise every day.”

「她有每天練習所需要的**自制力 / 自律**。」

Practice 3

> “Good study habits take time and **discipline**.”

「良好的學習習慣需要時間和**自律**。」

discipline = 即使不容易，也能控制自己並持續做應該做的事的能力

Common:

- * self-discipline
- * personal discipline
- * mental discipline
- * require discipline
- * develop discipline

2. **discipline** = system of rules and controlled behaviour (紀律) — 紀律；規範

Discipline can mean a system in which people are expected to obey rules and behave in an orderly, controlled way.

Practice 4

> “The school places great importance on **discipline**.”

「這間學校非常重視**紀律**。」

Practice 5

> “The army depends on strict **discipline**.”

「軍隊依靠嚴格的**紀律**運作。」

discipline = 透過規則、秩序和行為標準來維持群體正常運作的制度或要求

Common:

- * school discipline

- * military discipline
- * maintain discipline
- * strict discipline

This is distinct from purely personal self-control.

3. **discipline = punishment or corrective action (懲戒) — 紀律處分 ; 懲戒**

Discipline can mean punishment or corrective measures used when someone breaks rules.

Practice 6

> “The employee faced **discipline** for repeated misconduct.”

「該員工因多次行為不當而面臨**紀律處分**。」

Practice 7

> “Parents have different views on **discipline**.”

「家長對如何**管教 / 懲戒**孩子有不同看法。」

discipline = 為糾正違規或不當行為而採取的懲戒、處分或管教措施

This is a major distinct sense.

4. **discipline = branch of knowledge / academic field (學科) — 學科 ; 專業領域**

Discipline can mean an established field of study or knowledge.

Practice 8

> “Psychology is an academic **discipline**.”

「心理學是一門學術**學科**。」

Practice 9

> “The project brings together experts from several **disciplines**.”

「這個項目集合了來自多個**學科領域**的專家。」

****discipline = 具有自己理論、方法和研究範圍的學術或專業領域****

Common:

- * academic discipline
- * scientific discipline
- * across disciplines
- * different disciplines

This is completely different from punishment or self-control.

5. ****discipline = structured training/practice (訓練) — 訓練；修習；規律鍛鍊****

****Discipline**** can refer to a structured practice or training system that requires sustained effort and control.

Practice 10

> “Martial arts require both physical and mental ****discipline****.”

「武術需要身體和精神上的****嚴格訓練 / 自律****。」

Practice 11

> “Meditation became a daily ****discipline**** for her.”

「冥想成了她每天固定進行的一種****修習 / 規律訓練****。」

****discipline = 一套需要長期、規律練習和自我控制的訓練方式****

For strict counting, this sits between #1 and #2, but it is useful enough to show because the noun can refer to the practice itself.

6. ****discipline = verb: train someone to behave/control themselves (訓練 / 管教) — 管教；訓練；使守紀律****

As a verb, ****discipline**** can mean training someone to obey rules, develop self-control, or behave properly.

Practice 12

> “Children need to learn how to ****discipline**** themselves.”

「孩子需要學會如何**自律 / 約束自己**。」

Practice 13

> “The coach **disciplined** the team to follow a strict routine.”

「教練訓練球隊遵守嚴格的日常安排。」

****discipline someone = 透過規範、訓練或約束，使某人學會控制行為並遵守要求****

7. ****discipline = verb: punish for breaking rules (處分) — 懲戒；處分****

As a verb, ****discipline**** also means to punish someone for breaking rules or behaving improperly.

Practice 14

> “The employee was ****disciplined**** for violating company policy.”

「該員工因違反公司政策而受到****紀律處分****。」

Practice 15

> “The school ****disciplined**** several students after the incident.”

「事件發生後，學校對幾名學生作出****紀律處分****。」

****discipline someone = 因違規或不當行為而正式處分 / 懲戒某人****

This is the verb counterpart of Meaning 3.

8. ****disciplined = self-controlled / orderly (有自律 / 有紀律) — 自律的；有紀律的****

This is the exact form used in your passage.

Practice 16 — Original

> “I was trying to become more ****disciplined****.”

「我當時正努力讓自己變得更加****自律****。」

Practice 17

> “She is very **disciplined** about her study routine.”

「她在學習習慣方面非常**自律**。」

Practice 18

> “The team played in a very **disciplined** way.”

「球隊踢得非常**有紀律、有組織**。」

disciplined = 能控制自己、遵守規律，並有系統地持續做應做的事情

This can apply both to:

* individuals → self-controlled

* groups/performance → orderly and rule-following

9. **disciplined** = trained according to a method/system (受過訓練的) — 受過嚴格訓練的

Practice 19

> “She has a highly **disciplined** approach to research.”

「她採用非常**嚴謹有系統**的研究方式。」

Practice 20

> “The dancers are technically **disciplined**.”

「這些舞者在技術上受過非常**嚴格的訓練**。」

This develops from structured training and orderly control.

Related form: **disciplinary**

Disciplinary means relating to discipline, especially punishment or enforcement of rules.

Practice 21

> “The company began **disciplinary** proceedings.”

「公司開始進行**紀律處分程序**。」

Practice 22

> “He attended a **disciplinary** hearing.”

「他出席了一場**紀律聆訊**。」

****disciplinary = 與違規處理、紀律管理或處分有關的****

Common:

- * disciplinary action
- * disciplinary hearing
- * disciplinary procedure
- * disciplinary measures

Related form: ****disciplinarian****

A ****disciplinarian**** is someone who strongly enforces rules and discipline.

Practice 23

> “The head teacher had a reputation as a strict ****disciplinarian****.”

「校長以嚴格的****紀律執行者 / 管教嚴厲的人****聞名。」

****disciplinarian = 非常重視規則、秩序並嚴格管教他人的人****

This can sound somewhat negative depending on context.

Useful compound: ****self-discipline****

****Self-discipline**** means the ability to control yourself without needing others to force or supervise you.

Practice 24

> “Working from home requires a lot of ****self-discipline****.”

「在家工作需要很強的****自律能力****。」

Practice 25

> “He developed the **self-discipline** to study every evening.”

「他培養出每天晚上溫習的**自律能力**。」

This is the most precise noun corresponding to your sentence's **disciplined**.

Important distinction: **discipline vs self-discipline**

discipline

can mean:

- * self-control
- * rules/order
- * punishment
- * field of study

self-discipline

specifically means:

> controlling **your own** behaviour and habits.

For your passage:

> **disciplined**

is closest to:

> **having self-discipline**

Important distinction: **discipline vs punishment**

punishment

means a penalty imposed because someone did something wrong.

discipline

can include punishment, but is broader.

It may involve:

- * rules
- * correction
- * training
- * teaching self-control

So:

> discipline ≠ always punishment

Important distinction: **discipline vs control**

control

is broad and means managing or restraining something.

discipline

usually suggests control according to rules, goals, standards, or habits.

- > control your anger
- > develop self-discipline

Important distinction: **disciplined vs strict**

strict

means demanding close obedience to rules.

disciplined

means behaving in a controlled, organized, consistent way.

- > strict teacher
- > disciplined student

A disciplined person does not necessarily have a strict personality.

Important distinction: ****disciplined vs organized****

****organized****

means arranging things effectively and systematically.

****disciplined****

adds:

- * self-control
- * consistency
- * ability to resist distraction
- * commitment to standards

Someone can be organized but not very disciplined about following the plan.

Important distinction: ****discipline vs subject****

In academics:

****subject****

= a topic or area taught/studied

****discipline****

= an established scholarly field with its own methods, concepts, and traditions

- > school subject
- > academic discipline

****Discipline**** is usually more formal and institutional.

Important distinction: ****discipline vs field****

****field****

is broad and can refer to an area of study, work, or professional activity.

****discipline****

more strongly suggests a recognized academic/professional body of knowledge.

> field of technology

> academic discipline of sociology

They often overlap.

Countability note

Discipline changes countability by sense.

Usually uncountable — self-control/order

> “She has great discipline.”

「她很有自律。」

> “The school needs better discipline.”

「學校需要更好的紀律。」

Countable — academic field

> “Linguistics is a discipline.”

「語言學是一門學科。」

> “Several disciplines were represented.”

「多個學科都有代表參與。」

Countable in some practice/training uses

> “Meditation is a spiritual discipline.”

「冥想是一種精神修習。」

This distinction is very useful for learners.

Useful collocations

* self-discipline

- * strict discipline
- * maintain discipline
- * impose discipline
- * academic discipline
- * scientific discipline
- * disciplinary action
- * disciplined approach
- * disciplined routine
- * discipline yourself

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **discipline**
- * **disciplines**
- * **disciplined**
- * **disciplining**
- * **disciplinary**
- * **disciplinarian**

Useful lexicalized extension:

- * **self-discipline**

There is also **interdisciplinary / multidisciplinary**, which connect strongly to the academic-field sense:

> interdisciplinary research

> = 跨學科研究

But these are better treated as extensions of **discipline = academic field**, not as extra meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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discipline — self-control	控制自己行為、習慣、情緒和努力，以持續達成目標的能力；
自律	
discipline — rules/order	透過規則和行為標準維持秩序的紀律制度
discipline — punishment	因違規或不當行為而採取的懲戒 / 紀律處分
discipline — academic field	具有自身理論、方法和研究範圍的學術 / 專業學科
discipline — structured practice	需要長期、規律訓練和自我控制的一套修習 / 訓練

	discipline — verb, train/control	訓練、管教，使某人學會自我控制並遵守規範
	discipline — verb, punish	因違規而正式處分或懲戒某人
	disciplined	自律、有紀律、做事有規律和控制力的
	disciplinary	與紀律管理、違規處理或處分有關的
	disciplinarian	嚴格要求別人遵守規則和紀律的人
	self-discipline	不依靠外界監督而能控制自己並持續按目標行事的能力

For your original sentence

> “I was trying to become more ****disciplined**** and independent.”

The exact meaning is:

****disciplined = 能更好地管理自己的時間、注意力和行為，並持續按照目標和計劃做事****

So:

> ****become more disciplined****

= ****變得更加自律 / 做事更加有紀律****

For your database, I would count ****5 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****discipline****:

1. ****self-control / self-discipline****
2. ****system of rules and orderly behaviour****
3. ****punishment/corrective action for breaking rules****
4. ****academic or professional field****
5. ****structured practice or training requiring sustained control****

For the verb, I would map two corresponding branches:

* ****train/control behaviour****

* ****punish for misconduct****

And I would keep ****disciplined / disciplinary / disciplinarian / self-discipline**** as family extensions rather than inflate the base count.